

Q: And will you continue to be with stock Android for future devices as well?

As of now, yes. We have no plans to change that.

Q: What about a Windows phone?

Maybe in the near future. We are looking at it and evaluating it. It is definitely one of the options before us, but I do not have definite answers as to when you can see a Micromax Windows Phone device. We are looking at it for both phones and tablets.

Q: Who do you consider your competition in the Indian market right now?

Just the top five players.

Q: You seem to be aping one of the top five brands, Samsung, in the way they do teaser ads...like you did with Micromax Canvas 4. You teased the world with Canvas 4 features one by one, like Samsung does for its devices. What is the idea behind this strategy?

It is not Samsung's strategy—it's a well-known marketing strategy. It's a marketing plot that people use to generate curiosity in the market place. One can only generate curiosity if the brand has some power. We have seen that in the last eight months Micromax has been able to develop that pull for the brand, with this teaser ad strategy. And we have never gone wrong with the expectations of the consumer. We began with Canvas HD, then Canvas 2 and then Canvas 4. If you see, we received around 11,500 pre-orders for Micromax

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6. It's time to generate a private key and a self-signed certificate for your Certificate Authority.

```
cd /etc/pki/myCA
```

```
openssl genrsa -out private/my-ca.key -des3 2048
```

Do remember the passphrase you give at this step.

7. Now create your self-signed certificate using the command shown below:

```
openssl req -new -x509 -key private/my-ca.key -days 365 > my-ca.crt
```

This certificate will be distributed to your users.

With this, the process of setting up a Certificate Authority is complete. Now you can make your self-signed certificate downloadable by your users through a Web browser. Let us next check out the process of signing a certificate.

1. First of all, generate a private key using the `openssl genrsa 1024 > mykey.key` command.
2. Then create the Certificate Signing Request using the `openssl req -new -key mykey.key -out mycsr.csr` command.
3. Now, as the Certificate Authority, sign the certificate using

Canvas 4 in less than 36 hours of opening the pre-booking. So the strategy clearly works.

Q: What was the idea behind pricing Canvas 4 so aggressively?

Micromax Canvas 4 is priced at Rs 17,999. The idea behind pricing it in this bracket is that there is a big gap in this price segment. The Rs 15,000-20,000 segment is very price-sensitive. Again, we are not here to make losses. We are also not here to make humongous amounts of money. We are here to make the right amount of money. We completely believe that it is all about the democratisation of technology. If I can package everything and still make money, why should the consumer suffer! Just because I am giving them fantabulous features, it does not mean I have to charge them a bomb.

Q: When you came on board, you probably had two challenges to face. The company lagged in its marketing strategies and in its product profile too. What challenge did you try to address first?

I tried handling both simultaneously. I felt the need of addressing both together and the founders of this firm have been very open minded about this. When I had my final presentation in November last year (and I had not joined the company then), they agreed on what had to be the final roadmap and what needed to be done. We do not have deep pockets in terms of the budget. We have ear-marked a certain amount of money vis-a-vis the competition and we took it on from there. And the rest, as they say, is history. **END** 

the `openssl ca -in mycsr.csr -out mycert.crt` command.

Your certificate is now ready to be used across multiple applications including the Web and e-mail. You can view information regarding this certificate in the `/etc/pki/myCA/newcerts/01.pem` file. Also, if you open `/etc/pki/myCA/serial`, you'll see that its contents have been updated to 2, which is the serial number for the next certificate to be signed. As a Certificate Authority, you can also revoke a certificate using the `openssl ca -revoke /etc/pki/myCA/newcerts/01.pem` command. Here `01.pem` is the file related to the first certificate that we've created.

So this was a brief overview of how to set up a Certificate Authority in RHEL5. You can use it for intranet applications management. And if you want to understand the functionality behind the Certificate Security, you can explore the cryptography concepts related to certificates like TLS/SSL handshakes, key distribution, cryptographic hashes, etc. **END** 

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